

Miguel Ángel Torres Montoya

Crime Economics · Urban Economics · Applied Econometrics · Spatial Methods
miguet2209@gmail.com | miguel.torres2@u.icesi.edu.co | +57 (316) 244-0219
GitHub | LinkedIn | Web-page

EDUCATION

Icesi University,	Colombia. Bachelor of Arts in Economics. GPA: 4.5/5.0. Graduate-level Coursework: Quantitative and Computational Methods (4.8), Advanced Macroeconomics (in progress).	Expected 2027
Universidad del Rosario,	Bogotá, Colombia. Real Analysis, Bogotá Summer School in Economics (in progress).	2026
Berchmans School,	Cali, Colombia. High School Diploma (<i>Bachiller</i>).	2022

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Spatial Disaggregation of GDP and Informality in Bogotá.

With Eduard F. Martínez-González.

Spatially disaggregates Bogotá's GDP using nighttime lights, DANE 2018 census data, and mobility data; maps informality via XGBoost/Neural Networks.

Gender Disparities in the Colombian Criminal Justice System.

Undergraduate Thesis. Supervised by Eduard F. Martínez-González and Daniel Mejía-Londoño.

Examines gender differences in criminal sentencing in Colombia's accusatory system exploiting a natural experiment.

Sentencing Process Analysis in the Colombian Accusatory System.

With Eduard F. Martínez-González and Daniel Mejía-Londoño.

Examines the full criminal justice pipeline from criminal notice to final court ruling, identifying procedural bottlenecks and sentencing disparities.

Construction of Economic Centres in Cali.

With Cámara de Comercio de Cali and Invest Pacific.

Delineates Cali's economic subcenters by sector using georeferenced firm-level data and a spatial activity index.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025 – present	Research Assistant, Center for Research in Economics and Finance (CIENFI), Universidad Icesi, Cali, Colombia. Supervisor: Eduard F. Martínez-González. Spatial Disaggregation of GDP for Bogotá. (With the Secretaría de Desarrollo Económico de Bogotá)
-----------------------	--

Nighttime lights (Suomi-NPP, NOAA-20), TransMilenio mobility data, and DANE 2018 census. Findings featured in *El Tiempo*, February 2025.

Property Registry Revaluation Analysis for Cali. (With the Alcaldía de Cali)
Descriptive analysis of the *reavalúo catastral*, focusing on property owner claims following the reassessment.

Data cienfi.
Open data repository for Business Analytics courses at Universidad Icesi.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2025 – present Teaching Monitor, Introduction to Business Analytics,
Universidad Icesi, Cali, Colombia.

AWARDS AND HONORS

2025 3rd Place, Undergraduate Presentation Competition on the Economics of Crime,
Universidad Icesi.

2024 2nd Place, “Who Wants to Be a Millionaire?” Economics Edition, Universidad Icesi.

2023 1st Place, Undergraduate Economic Debate Competition, Universidad Icesi.

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

World Bank Group, via edX.
Evaluating Impact in Low- and Middle-Income Countries (in progress). 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: R (Advanced), Python (Intermediate).

Geospatial: Google Earth Engine (rgee), QGIS.

Other Tools: Excel (Advanced), LaTeX, Git, PowerPoint, Canva.

Methods: Machine Learning (XGBoost, k-NN, Neural Networks), Spatial Econometrics, Remote Sensing, Statistical Modeling, Data Visualization.

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native.

English: Professional Working Proficiency (C1).